Story Board Outline

Low Tide Radio · Exported 19 Oct 2026 · Source: Current Story Board

Act One: The Call

Note: Setup. Ends when Anjali finds the reel. 12 scenes.

Sequence: Static

Note: 1999 prologue, then Bengaluru and the journey home.

Scene Card 1 · EXT. OPEN SEA - NIGHT (1999): Prologue. A storm. Fishing boats in the swell and a woman's voice on the radio reading positions.

Note: Story day: Night of 14 November 1999. Characters: MARIAMMA, VARGHESE.

Scene Card 2 · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT (1999): Mariamma at the transmitter. Young Anjali asleep under the desk. The lights die.

Note: Story day: Night of 14 November 1999. Characters: MARIAMMA, YOUNG ANJALI, JOE.

Scene Card 3 · INT. SOUNDWAVE STUDIO - BENGALURU - DAY: Present day. Anjali scrubs breaths out of a detergent ad. Fathima calls: Appachan is missing.

Note: Story day: Day 1. Characters: ANJALI, STUDIO PRODUCER, FATHIMA.

Scene Card 4 · INT. KSRTC BUS - MOVING - NIGHT: The overnight bus to Kochi. Anjali listens to an old cassette of her mother on air.

Note: Story day: Night 1. Characters: ANJALI, MARIAMMA.

Scene Card 5 · EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - DAWN: Anjali arrives. Appachan sits at the foot of the mast with his dog Kannan. Inspector Latha waits by her jeep.

Note: Story day: Day 2. Characters: ANJALI, APPACHAN, LATHA.

Scene Card 6 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY: Tea with Fathima. The Port Trust notice on the fridge: demolition in seven days.

Note: Story day: Day 2. Characters: ANJALI, FATHIMA, APPACHAN.

Sequence: Seven Days

Note: The ticking clock. Anjali meets Suresh and finds the reel.

Scene Card 7 · EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - DAY: Anjali walks the harbour. Fishermen remember her mother. Suresh runs a survey crew and does not want her there.

Note: Story day: Day 2. Characters: ANJALI, SURESH.

Scene Card 8 · INT. PORT TRUST OFFICE - DAY: Anjali asks for access to the station. The Port Officer refuses. Suresh watches.

Note: Story day: Day 3. Characters: ANJALI, PORT OFFICER, SURESH.

Scene Card 9 · INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - NIGHT: The school radio club meets over tea. Rahul asks Anjali to look at their homemade transmitter.

Note: Story day: Day 3. Characters: FATHIMA, RAHUL, ANJALI.

Scene Card 10 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - NIGHT: In a clear moment Appachan gives Anjali the station keys. He speaks in Malayalam.

Note: Story day: Day 3. Characters: APPACHAN, ANJALI.

Scene Card 11 · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT: Anjali and Rahul let themselves in. The tape shelves are empty except for one reel dated 14-11-1999.

Note: Story day: Day 3. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL.

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Scene Card 12 · EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - NIGHT: A security guard spots their torches. They run. Rahul's bicycle chain comes off.

Note: Story day: Day 3. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL.

Beat: Tone: the sea before the story. No titles until the static cuts out.

Beat: Inciting incident: Fathima's call. Appachan was found at the station.

Beat: First turn: the reel dated 14-11-1999.

Act Two: The Reel

Note: Confrontation. Restoring the tape, the storm, the logbook and Joe's confession.

Sequence: Oxide

Note: The technical problem and the village's resistance.

Scene Card 13 · INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - DAY: Anjali examines the reel. Sticky-shed damage. It has to be baked before it can be played once.

Note: Story day: Day 4. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL, FATHIMA.

Scene Card 14 · INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - KITCHEN - DAY: They bake the reel in a borrowed bakery convection oven, watched like a newborn.

Note: Story day: Day 4. Characters: FATHIMA, RAHUL, ANJALI.

Scene Card 15 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - VERANDA - DAY: Appachan mistakes Anjali for Mariamma and scolds her for being late for her shift.

Note: Story day: Day 4. Characters: APPACHAN, ANJALI.

Scene Card 16 · INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - NIGHT: First playback. Static, a laugh, half a sentence in Mariamma's voice. Then the tape stops.

Note: Story day: Day 4. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL, FATHIMA, MARIAMMA.

Scene Card 17 · INT. JOE'S ROOM ABOVE THE TODDY SHOP - DAY: Anjali visits Joe. He will not talk about that night and asks her to leave.

Note: Story day: Day 5. Characters: ANJALI, JOE.

Scene Card 18 · EXT. ST. ANTONY'S CHURCH - DAY: The memorial mass for the men lost in 1999. Suresh reads the names. Anjali stands at the back.

Note: Story day: Day 5. Characters: SURESH, ANJALI, FATHIMA.

Scene Card 19 · INT. POLICE OUTPOST - DAY: Latha warns Anjali about the trespass complaint, then quietly shows her the 1999 file.

Note: Story day: Day 5. Characters: LATHA, ANJALI.

Scene Card 20 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT: Anjali and Fathima read the file. Fathima talks about her uncle for the first time.

Note: Story day: Day 5. Characters: ANJALI, FATHIMA.

Sequence: Storm Warning

Note: Midpoint. Appachan is lost in the storm and Suresh brings him back.

Scene Card 21 · EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DAY: The radio club flies an antenna kite. Anjali teaches them to call the harbour.

Note: Story day: Day 6. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL, FATHIMA.

Scene Card 22 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - NIGHT: Appachan's bed is empty. The door is open. Kannan is gone too.

Note: Story day: Day 6. Characters: ANJALI.

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Scene Card 23 · EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - NIGHT: The village searches in the storm with torches. Suresh's crew brings the site floodlights.

Note: Story day: Day 6. Characters: ANJALI, SURESH, FATHIMA, RAHUL.

Scene Card 24 · EXT. HARBOUR BREAKWATER - NIGHT: Suresh finds Appachan at the end of the breakwater with Kannan, waving a torch at the sea. He carries him back.

Note: Midpoint. Stunt and marine safety plan applies. Protect a full night for it.

Comment (Open) from Meenakshi Varma: This is the midpoint. Protect the time for it on the schedule.

Scene Card 25 · INT. TALUK HOSPITAL - WARD - NIGHT: Appachan on a drip. Suresh tells Anjali about his father and the Little Flower.

Note: Story day: Night 6. Characters: SURESH, ANJALI, APPACHAN.

Scene Card 26 · INT. TALUK HOSPITAL - CORRIDOR - DAWN: An uneasy truce. Suresh gives Anjali one day inside the station.

Note: Story day: Day 7. Characters: SURESH, ANJALI.

Scene Card 27 · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - TAPE ROOM - DAY: In the flooded basement they find the station logbook in a sealed ammunition box.

Note: Story day: Day 7. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL, SURESH.

Scene Card 28 · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - DAY: The logbook: entries stop at 23:40. 'Main power cut by order. J. D'Cruz.'

Note: Story day: Day 7. Characters: ANJALI, SURESH, RAHUL.

Beat: Midpoint: Suresh carries Appachan off the breakwater.

Note: Everything turns on Suresh choosing to help.

Beat: Low point: the logbook names Joe.

Sequence: What Joe Did

Note: The confession and the restored second half of the reel.

Scene Card 29 · EXT. TODDY SHOP - NIGHT: Anjali confronts Joe in front of the drinkers. He walks out to his car.

Note: Story day: Day 7. Characters: ANJALI, JOE.

Scene Card 30 · EXT. LIGHTHOUSE ROAD - NIGHT: Joe drives drunk. Latha's jeep pulls him over before the bend.

Note: Story day: Day 7. Characters: JOE, LATHA.

Scene Card 31 · INT. POLICE OUTPOST - CELL - NIGHT: Joe confesses: the Port ordered the power cut. Mariamma kept going on a battery set.

Note: Story day: Night 7. Characters: JOE, LATHA, ANJALI.

Scene Card 32 · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT (1999): Flashback. In the dark Mariamma connects the battery set. Joe leaves. Young Anjali watches.

Note: Story day: Night of 14 November 1999. Characters: MARIAMMA, JOE, YOUNG ANJALI.

Scene Card 33 · INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - NIGHT: The second half of the reel plays. Mariamma relays positions. Varghese answers.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL, FATHIMA, MARIAMMA, VARGHESE.

Scene Card 34 · EXT. OPEN SEA - LITTLE FLOWER - NIGHT (1999): Flashback. Varghese turns the fleet toward the river mouth, then goes back for the Seagull.

Note: Story day: Night of 14 November 1999. Characters: VARGHESE, MARIAMMA.

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Act Three: The Broadcast

Note: Resolution. Listening night, the last transmission and the demolition.

Sequence: Listening Night

Note: The village hears the reel.

Scene Card 35 · INT. SURESH'S HOUSE - DAY: Anjali brings Suresh the recording. He listens alone to his father's voice.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: ANJALI, SURESH, VARGHESE.

Scene Card 36 · INT. PORT TRUST OFFICE - DAY: Suresh asks Krishnadas to delay. Refused. He arranges power for one more night instead.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: SURESH, PORT OFFICER.

Scene Card 37 · EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DUSK: The village sets up for listening night: speakers, lanterns, a generator truck.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: FATHIMA, RAHUL, SURESH, JOE.

Scene Card 38 · INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - DUSK: Appachan dresses in his best shirt and asks where Mariamma is. Anjali tells him gently.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: APPACHAN, ANJALI.

Scene Card 39 · EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - NIGHT: Listening night. The reel plays over speakers. Suresh reads the fleet names. Joe stays.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: ANJALI, SURESH, APPACHAN, FATHIMA, RAHUL, JOE, LATHA, MARIAMMA, VARGHESE.

Scene Card 40 · EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - ROOF - NIGHT: Rahul and Anjali send the broadcast out from the old mast one last time.

Note: Story day: Day 8. Characters: ANJALI, RAHUL.

Sequence: Low Tide

Note: The building falls; the station lives on.

Scene Card 41 · EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - DAY: Demolition. The excavator bites. The mast comes down. Appachan watches without fear.

Note: Story day: Day 9. Characters: ANJALI, APPACHAN, SURESH, FATHIMA.

Scene Card 42 · INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - DAY: The radio club paints a sign: Low Tide Radio. Anjali calls Bengaluru and resigns.

Note: Story day: Day 9. Characters: ANJALI, FATHIMA, RAHUL, STUDIO PRODUCER.

Scene Card 43 · EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - DAWN: The boats go out. On the radio, Anjali reads the weather.

Note: Story day: Day 10. Characters: ANJALI.

Scene Card 44 · EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DAY: Low tide. Anjali and Appachan walk on the wet sand with Kannan. The end.

Note: Story day: Day 10. Characters: ANJALI, APPACHAN.

Beat: Climax: listening night and the last transmission.

Parking Lot

Scene Card: Pappan on the storm

Scene Card · INT. COAST RADIO STATION - STAIRWELL - DAY: Cut idea: Anjali records the sound of the station before demolition and builds a sound map.

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Scene Card: Alternative opening

Note: Open on the demolition and tell the film as the week before it. Parked: it gives away the ending.

Beat: Alternative opening

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